

Satellite

Satellites zoom around the Earth high above us, held in orbit by gravity.

Technology that's OUT OF THIS WORLD!



Space tower

Russian scientist **Konstantin Tsiolkovsky** came up with the idea of building a **tower into space**, with a satellite at the top that could be used by spaceships on their way to **OTHER PLANETS**. He worked out the math to make it happen, but his ideas never got off the ground.

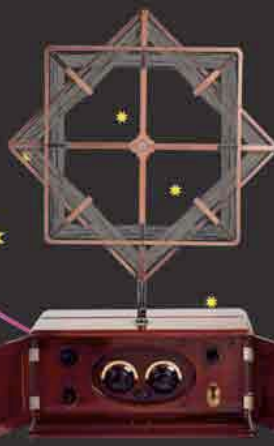
By the way...

I was way ahead of my time: I developed an equation about rockets in 1903 that's still used today!

It couldn't have happened without...



Alessandro Volta invented the world's first **BATTERY**, the voltaic pile, in 1800.



RADIO SIGNALS are used both to direct satellites and to receive information from them.

Sputnik 1 was the size of a beach ball.

Space Race

The world's first **satellite**, *Sputnik 1*, was rocketed into orbit by the Soviet Union in 1957. The country's bitter rival, the United States, had been **developing its own satellite** and was furious to have lost the first episode of what became known as the Space Race. The first US satellite, **EXPLORER 1**, was launched just three months later.

